

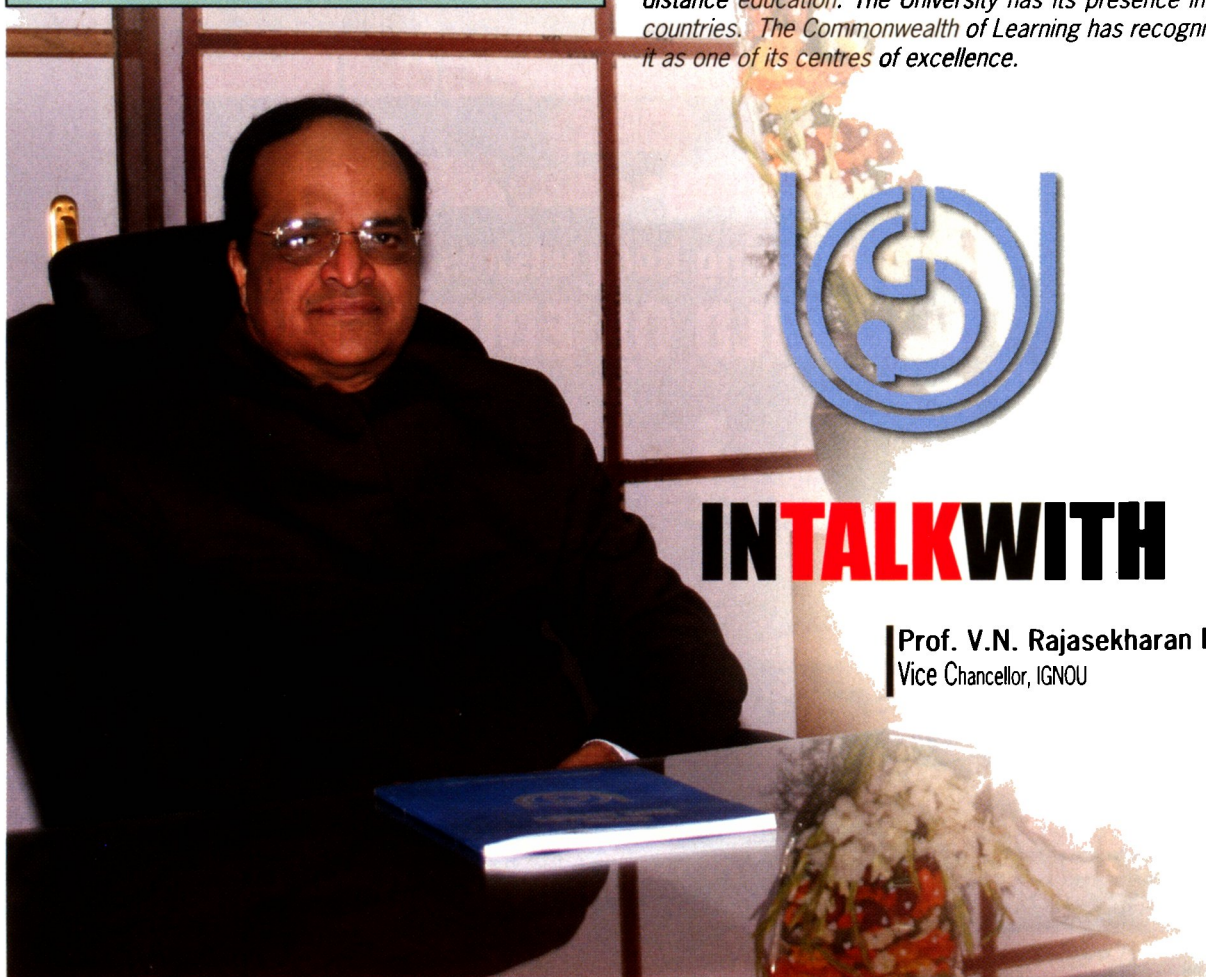
TOWARDS A GLOBAL KNOWLEDGE-BASED SOCIETY

Prof. V.N. Rajasekharan Pillai has been at the helm of affairs of many higher education institutions during his career spanning over 35 years. His experiences and contributions to the field of science and educational administration are rich and varied. He has served as the Chairman and Vice-Chairman of the University Grants Commission (UGC), Govt of India, New Delhi, served as the Director of the National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC), Bangalore, Vice-Chancellor of the Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam, Vice-Chancellor (Acting) of the Cochin University of Science and Technology, Founder-Director of the School of Chemical Sciences, Dean of Faculty of Science, Controller of Examinations, Director of College Development Council, Founder-Director of the School of Professional Distance Education and Chief, Employment and Information Guidance Bureau of the Mahatma Gandhi University. He is a Fellow of the prestigious Indian Academy of Sciences and an Honorary Senior Fellow of the Jawaharlal Nehru Centre.

The Indira Gandhi National Open University better known as IGNOU, was envisaged as a centre of excellence that will not only impart education and knowledge through various means suited to the Open and Distance Education Mode, but also encourage, coordinate and assist Open Universities and Distance Education systems while determining standards in such systems in the country.

Established by an Act of Parliament in 1985, the University today, serves the educational aspirations of about 1.5 million students in India and 35 countries abroad through 11 Schools of Studies. The success of the University in its stated objective of democratising higher education and providing access to all segments of people, can be gauged from the fact that, about 10% of all students enrolled in higher education in the country are enrolled with IGNOU.

Apart from teaching and research, extension and training form the mainstay of its academic activities. It also acts as a national resource centre; and more importantly, functions as an apex body to promote and maintain standards of distance education. The University has its presence in 35 countries. The Commonwealth of Learning has recognised it as one of its centres of excellence.



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Vice Chancellor, IGNOU